

Article	Type	Reputation, History, and background of Journal, Author and Editor	Year of publication	Reliability
"Aspartame's Hidden Dangers"	Tertiary	- The author is a doctor of osteopathic medicine - NYT bestselling author - Written over 30 scientific studies and reports - Author is known for spreading misinformation & selling products related to Covid-19 (received warning letter from the FDA) (Correll, 2021) - Newsletter is full of "cherry-picked half-truths" (Jarry, 2024)	N/A	1
"Aspartame: a safety evaluation based on current use levels, regulations, and toxicological epidemiological studies"	Secondary	- Taylor & Francis Group is a British company that publishes books and peer-reviewed academic journals. - The authors of this safety review are part of the Burdock Group, a food safety and regulatory compliance consultancy. - It is stated in the acknowledgments that the review panel was selected by Dr. William Waddell, and the panelists remained anonymous to the sponsoring group, with no known conflicts of interest or potential biases. - The article is from 2008, 18 years ago, and may have issues with currency. - Has received criticism for charging authors a fee to "expedite the peer review process" (Subramanian, 2022) to have their articles published sooner.	10 October 2008	4
"Evidence for consciousness-related anomalies in random physical systems"	Secondary	- Since it was published so long ago, it lacks the currency and is at significant risk of being out of date. - Study was funded majorly from James S. McDonnell Foundation, Inc. and the John E. Fetzer Foundation, Inc. - Involved assistance from Dr. York Dobyns - Roger D. Nelson is a director of the Global Consciousness Project (GCP) - Dean I. Radin is a Professor of Integral and Transpersonal Psychology and the Chief Scientist at IONS - Has 180+ scientific articles - Published by Springer in the journal Foundations of Physics	12 June 1989	3

		- single-blind peer-reviewed journal		
"Glyphosate's Suppression of Cytochrome P450 Enzymes and Amino Acid Biosynthesis by the Gut Microbiome: Pathways to Modern Diseases"	Secondary	- MDPI is one of the largest publishers in the world, publishing over 390 peer-reviewed journals. - The co-authors are an independent scientist and computer scientist. - The computer scientist co-author has received criticisms for their "equating correlation with causation" (Novella, 2014), as they identify the use of glyphosphates with the number of children with autism. - The computer scientist co-author has also received criticism with their anti-vaccine stances; they remain an editor for an anti-vaccine journal. - A note has been added by the publisher that indicates there are concerns over potential bias in opinions and choice of sources in the article.	18 April 2013	2
"Influence of Dietary Advice Including Green Vegetables, Beef, and Whole Dairy Products on Recurrent Upper Respiratory Tract Infections in Children: A Randomized Controlled Trial"	Primary	- As stated above, MDPI is a very large publisher who is very reputable. - The co-authors on the article vary in both fields, with some only having 1-2 publications and others with over 20. - As a primary source, the article details its methods, materials, and results from experiments, claiming a "randomized controlled trial". - In their "methods" section, they detail potential biases and how they were avoided through analysis to find any influence on the outcome measures, as well as tests to identify any categorical variable bias. - The article is from 2020, making it recent and current.	20 January 2020	5

Explanations:

For the first article, we chose a reliability of 1. Whilst the author is a doctor, NYT best seller and has 30 scientific studies they are also known for spreading misinformation, receiving warning letters from the FDA(Correll, 2021) and "cherry picking half-truths" (Jerry, 2024). Due to these reasons, we decided to go for a reliability of 1.

For the second article, we chose a reliability of 4. The publisher publishes peer-reviewed content exclusively whilst having the authors be part of a known food safety and regulatory

compliance consultancy, the Burdock Group. Furthermore, the criticism relates not to the content but to the charging of an authors fee. For these reasons, we chose a reliability of 4.

For the 3rd article, we chose a reliability of 3. Being released so long ago runs the risk of outdated/irrelevant information which lowers the reliability however, the authors Roger D. Nelson and Dean I. Radin being prominent figures helps increase the reliability. Furthermore, the study being funded by two different corporations whilst getting assistance from Dr. York Dobyns helps further increase the reliability. For these reasons, we chose a reliability of 3.

For the fourth article, we chose a reliability of 2. While MDPI is one of the largest publishers in the world, the authors "equating correlation with causation" (Novella, 2014) and anti-vaccine stances lower their credibility. Furthermore, a note indicating potential bias in the opinions and choice of sources further hurt the reliability yet having MDPI as their publisher keeps their credibility from 1 to a 2. So for these reasons we chose a reliability of 2.

For the 5th and final article, we chose a reliability of 5. Having MDPI again as a publisher greatly helps with credibility and being released relatively recently helps further increase their credibility. Furthermore, detailing potential biases and how they were avoided raises their reliability even more. For these reasons, we chose a reliability of 5.

Bibliography

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